

KF25 Expanded Version of Teachings

Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

“Search me, O God, and know my heart. Examine me and know my thoughts. See if there is any way in me that causes pain, and lead me in the ways of eternity.” (Psalm 139:23–24)

0:01 OPENING

0:02 PRESENTING

0:06 KARIS CIRCULATION

0:07 GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS

0:08 MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING

When dogs learn to live and work in a human community, they develop acute abilities to gauge every expression and sound that humans make. Several years ago, we lived in the north of England near a sheep farm. From our kitchen window we could watch the sheepdogs moving out into the field and then waiting, simply waiting, for a signal from the shepherd. The dogs were in a state of relaxed attention—relaxed, but all eyes and ears alert, each dog eagerly watching the shepherd for its particular signal. These dogs were not anxious to take on another dog’s business, nor were they impatient with their work of shepherding sheep. They understood that in the natural order of things there are dogs and there are masters, and there is a job to be done. They had no fear and no opposing pride. They knew without any doubt that their business was to follow their particular signal from the shepherd. Together, the dogs and the shepherd accomplished the mission. These dogs were designed and trained for their work, and they seemed to rejoice in their work as they fulfilled their design. We, too, are creatures designed to joyfully accomplish a particular work, and we also need training.

Meditation trains us to patiently and purposefully wait on the Lord with our mental and energetic eyes and ears alert. When we have learned to mindfully wait, our Shepherd can trust us to watch for His signals and skillfully complete our mission. It is in carrying out our mission skillfully that we find the joy.

Let’s continue practicing **Centering Prayer**.¹ Assume a meditation posture and breathe. *(Pause)* Begin with silent prayer, resting in the spirit and in the breath. You might try standing up during this practice while maintaining a sense of connection between heaven and earth. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

And now, ask God for a *word*. Remember that this can be an image, a word, or a phrase. Allow the word to surface in your consciousness. If nothing surfaces, just relax into the breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Use the word to focus your mind on stillness and on the breath. Stick to this word during your meditation time. When other thoughts intrude, gently return to your word. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

When you are ready, allow the word to float away, and then rest in the stillness of your mind. You might attend to the word for one breath and then rest in the stillness for two breaths. To balance your breathing,

try inhaling and exhaling for equal amounts of time. Practice for one minute. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

And now, if you can, let go of the word entirely. You might continue with the balanced breath, inhaling and exhaling for equal amounts of time. Practice resting in the stillness, the quiet mind, for one minute. If your mind starts to wander, use the word to draw your mind back to the breath. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Take a deep fresh breath as if you were stretching your insides. Gently open your eyes and re-engage with your environment.

Try to find a regular time in your day for meditation. In the evening, you may be too busy or too fatigued to meditate, so you might try scheduling an afternoon meditation. Take a break at work and find a quiet conference room where you can spend a few minutes in meditation, perhaps before you leave the office. Use your meditation practice to refresh your mind. Your cue to watch TV or to surf on the web might be converted into a cue to meditate first. Tell those living with you what you are doing and ask for their support.

Our scripture for this meditation is Isaiah 40:31, reading from the King James Version.

But they that wait upon the Lord shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings as eagles; they shall run and not be weary; and they shall walk and not faint.

Let's learn to wait on the Lord. Take a deep breath.

(Go straight to the Karis Confession to allow time for the longer Toolbox)

0:20 KARIS CONFESSION

0:21 TOOLBOX

This month our focus is on KF Confession 6:

We chose to foster illusions to save the life of our Idol Self.

In this lesson, we will learn the **T-A-T** integration method.² **T-A-T** is the acronym for **Tapas Acupressure Technique**. The **T-A-T** can help you find clarity when you are caught in a story that is fostering illusions. It can also help you get back into reality when you find yourself going down the Judgment Path. In this lesson, we will move quickly through the steps of the **T-A-T**, but you can find a more detailed presentation of this technique at [Alison's tapping and TAT videos](#).

Each Idol type has its own characteristic hotspots, and we can predict the types of situations that will trigger them. When these hotspots are triggered, they drive us into habitual reactions and feelings. If you have reviewed the chapters in *Neurosis and Human Growth* that apply to your Idol type, you are armed with a list of your hotspots and can boldly confront them with new understanding.³ You can now correlate your strong feelings with those hotspots and recognize that your stories about those feelings are more likely to be a reflection of your hurt pride than a representation of reality. These stories are often designed to suppress the True Self and restore your Idol's comfort zone. Resigned people may not feel strong feelings, or they may only allow themselves to feel anger or frustration. They might, however, notice behaviors that indicate that unconscious emotions are driving them.

Mindfulness training helps you notice when the fumes of hurt pride are building up in the cylinders of your self-hate engine, ready to be ignited by your hotspots. Simply noticing that these fumes are building up can help you take a step toward redirecting the outcome of those situations.

Expansive types hit hotspots when they feel helpless and vulnerable, sense disrespect from others, or feel they have lost control. Self-effacing types ignite their self-hate when they stick up for themselves or invest in their own potential. Resigned types flare up against imposition, especially the imposition of their own internal conflicts and feelings. All types will hate themselves for having the *wrong* kind of feelings—that is, feelings that seem wrong to them.

In general, we foster illusions about ourselves and life to support our Idol's pride system. Illusions help us avoid the normal discomforts of being alive and awake human beings. If we are committed to the Idol, we must unconsciously resist the awareness of our natural human condition, our real feelings, and the law of cause and effect in our lives. Our Idol Self is so vulnerable that we simply cannot afford to acknowledge our real vulnerability as creatures living in a material world. While we are distracting ourselves with comfortable illusions, self-hate fumes are building up within. We are often just as shocked as the people around us when those fumes explode.

When you are caught in a story that is fostering your illusions about yourself and about how your life should be, you can use the **T-A-T** to regain clarity. The **T-A-T** method helps us stay inside our skin and connect with our own business and real feelings. When we choose to practice the **T-A-T** intervention, we assume responsibility for our own feelings and thoughts. We take back the power over what we are thinking, feeling, and experiencing. You might use your **Meeting Preparation Guide** or your KF journal to jot down a few notes about what you experience during this **T-A-T** training.

The T-A-T

Begin by identifying the ring finger and thumb on one of your hands. With these two fingers, gently grasp the bridge of your nose, between your eyes. *(Pause)* When you are comfortable with that position, adjust your arm and wrist so that you can place the middle finger of the same hand on your lower middle forehead, about half an inch higher than the area between your eyebrows. *(Pause)* You are now lightly touching three facial points with your fingertips. This is called the *pose*. Hold that pose during each of the **T-A-T** steps. While you hold the pose, breathe deeply and follow the instructions. Remember to breathe deeply throughout the exercise.

Take this gently. During the pause, spend as much time as you need for to jot down some notes about your experience.

1. Choose an issue or problem. *(Pause) (Repeat the instruction)*

You might want to choose one of your hotspots as your problem. Observe yourself enduring the experience of that hotspot. What are you thinking and feeling? Are you feeling hurt, defensive, enraged, or scared? If you can, experience the sensations in your body when you access those feelings. What stories or judgments are in your mind? *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Hold the pose and breathe for thirty seconds. *(Pause for 30 seconds)* In this first step, people sometimes use positive affirmations to talk themselves out of the problem or their feelings. They are trying to save their lives. Remain focused on the problem for another thirty seconds while continuing to hold the pose. Breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Now pause. Take as long as you wish to jot down a few words that will help you remember what you thought and felt about the problem. On a scale of one to ten, with ten being the most intense, rate the intensity of your discomfort about the problem or the amount of resistance that you feel while exploring this issue. Make a note of that.

Take the pose again, and breathe.

2. **Imagine how you would think and feel, and what your life might be like, if you did not have this problem. (Pause for 1 minute) (Repeat the instruction) (Pause for 1 minute)**

Pause and take as long as you need to jot down a few descriptive words.

Now take the pose again, and breathe.

3. **Listen to the clearing statement: “God, thank You for healing the origins of this problem.” (Pause for 1 minute) “The origins of this problem are healing now.” (Pause for 1 minute)**

Pause. Jot down a few notes. How are you feeling?

Take the pose again and keep breathing.

4. **Listen to the clearing statement: “God, thank You for healing all the areas of my life, mind, and body that are misoriented by this problem.” (Pause for 1 minute) “All the areas of my life, mind, and body that are misoriented by this problem are healing now.” (Pause for 1 minute)**

Pause. If you have any thoughts about that, write them down now.

Take the pose, and breathe.

5. **Listen to the clearing statement: “God, thank You for healing all the places in me that get something out of holding on to this problem.” (Pause for 1 minute) “All the places in me that get something out of holding on to this problem are healing now.” (Pause for 1 minute)**

Pause. If you have any thoughts, jot a few of them down.

The next step leads us into forgiveness. We will learn more about forgiveness later in KF training, but for right now, think of forgiveness as simply letting go of something that you are holding on to.

Take the pose, and breathe.

6. **Listen to the clearing statement: “I forgive everyone and everything that I have blamed for this problem, including God and myself.” Breathe, and on the exhale, let go. (Pause for 1 minute) “I forgive everyone and everything that I have held responsible for this problem, including God and myself.” Breathe, and on the exhale, let go. (Pause for 1 minute)**

Pause. Jot down any thoughts that you might have.

Take the pose and breathe deeply one more time.

7. Listen to the clearing statement: *“I ask forgiveness from everyone and everything that I have harmed by holding on to this problem, including God’s purposes and my True Self.”* Breathe. (Pause for 1 minute) *“I ask forgiveness from everyone and everything that I have harmed by holding on to this problem, including God’s purposes and my True Self.”* Breathe. (Pause for 1 minute)

Pause. Make a note of any thoughts you might have.

Write down how you now feel about the problem. On a scale of one to ten, how would you rate the intensity of your discomfort or resistance when you think about this problem? Compare this number with your assessment in step 1.

The **T-A-T** can help you honor your emotions without allowing them to enslave you and drive you to conclude your tension. When you honor and then disarm your emotions, you can wait more patiently and purposefully for the Shepherd’s signal.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Holy Spirit, remind me to practice my KF tools so that I might use them skillfully. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

0:30 SHARING

1:00 BIBLE TEACHING

This month our focus is on KF Confession 6:

We chose to foster illusions to save the life of our Idol Self.

Last week we looked at John’s disciples and their response to the light of the truth. John presented them with an opportunity to replace their own logic, which was based on the laws of their Idol system, with a new logic based on the light of Jesus and the karis relationship with God.

During this lesson, we will spend a little time talking about the *hope of the glory of God*. We were given an imagination for a reason; imagination is the instrument of hope. By using our imagination, we can envision an oriented, glorious life—a life that co-relates or correlates with the reality of the Person of God; a life that demonstrates and displays the character of God so that as He is, so are we in this world.⁴ We can also imagine the real destructive consequences of refusing to develop that glorious life. Those consequences are briefly summarized in the first chapter of Paul’s letter to the Romans. Our desire to avoid such consequences can be a powerful incentive to choose orientation when events trigger our hotspots. The vision of real glory is like a beacon that guides the lifeboat of our True Self out of chaos and into the light of our potential in Christ.

Let’s look at **Romans 5:2** in my translation.

²Through Jesus we have patronage and access to this karis relationship in which we stand; and we exult in hope of the glory of God. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

Do you wonder what *exult* means? It means *to show or feel a lively or triumphant joy; to be highly elated or jubilant*.⁵ That is how Christians are supposed to feel about the hope of the glory of God. Isn't that interesting?

What is glory? Glory is the expression of the true character of something wonderful, authentic, and real. That expression is then observed by others who add to the glory by appreciating and praising what they see. A good reputation is glorious. In the Bible, glory is often described as light and can be understood as energy that is radiant, unfettered, and unpolluted by misorientation. We may not be aware of our own glory, but as children of light we shine with a radiant energy and express a unique quality that can be seen by others.⁶

When we do the **T-A-T** intervention, we are asked to imagine what life would be like without our problem. We recall the Believe It Path and imagine how we might have acted in a healthier manner or how we might have allowed another person space to grow. We might also imagine what it is like to live in another person's shoes. That's called *empathy*. When we use our imagination as God intended, we are living in the hope that as we continue our work, we will be able to increasingly express the character of God and the quality of our design. This is the hope of the glory of God, and it is the glory that God intends for each one of us. This glory is not legalistic perfection; it is active, productive, vital growth.

The Idol has a hope, too. It hopes to actualize its illusions. We were designed to be glorious, but the Idol switches the track of that glorious design and shunts our God-given express train onto a rail siding of imagined glory leading nowhere. God intended our imagination to be harnessed for exploration and development and for contributing to our community, but the Idol hijacks and enslaves that beautiful imagination and uses it to foster illusions about ourselves, others, and the future—and even to rewrite the past. Our amazing, God-designed imagination is also mercilessly employed by the Idol to punish us with anxieties about the past, the future, and life, and to lash us with self-torment. By abusing the power of this great gift, the Idol distorts reality, discounts or ignores real evidence, and transports us into a fantasy world where we can escape what is true. Our imagination then serves the “*Hope of the Glory of Me!*”, and we use it to manufacture a spurious confidence in our own prideful judgments and to glorify our paltry, egocentric achievements. Our misoriented hope is that our Idol Self will be glorified, perfected, and actualized in the material world.

Whenever you start a thought with “if only,” you are living in the “*Hope of the Glory of Me!*” For example, you might think: *If only I had other parents, genetics, other bosses, a different home, or another spouse or body . . . if only I hadn't done that . . . if only they would do this . . . if only I was gifted with his looks, her talent, his brains, her opportunities—then wouldn't I be glorious?* But God's hope for you is that you develop the core strength of love which casts out all fear wherever you are and in whatever situation you find yourself. God has a thousand ideas for your future, all of which will delight and stretch you at the same time, but He's not just looking to please you. His great hope is that you will fulfill your glorious potential and co-labor with Him to rescue this sorry, messed-up world.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Father, show me Your vision for me today. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about the Bible teaching?”)

1:10 INTEGRATION

Sip some clean water and prepare to take some notes. Assume a meditation posture, and breathe. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Here is our integration focus: *Consider expressing the glory of God through your life. (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

The FAITH Process

(Choose from each section a few sentences that are meaningful to you)

Feelings

As you *consider expressing the glory of God through your life*, how does it feel? *(Pause)* Your feelings are yours to teach you about yourself, to guide you, and to train you. They can often be uncomfortable. *(Pause)* You can learn to recognize and honor your feelings without allowing them to master you. Recognize with compassion whatever you are experiencing, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Awareness without judgment

Gently hold whatever you are experiencing in your awareness. *(Pause)* You might notice a compulsion to push thoughts or feelings away, to judge them, or to justify them. We often flush our real feelings or thoughts from our consciousness before they have a chance to teach us. Observe whatever you may be experiencing as you *consider expressing the glory of God through your life*. *(Pause)* Feelings and passing thoughts are not right or wrong; they just are. Give yourself permission now to explore them without judgment, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Inquiry: What is my body saying?

Bring your attention to your body and notice what it is doing when you *consider expressing the glory of God through your life*. What sensations are there? *(Pause)* Your body is always talking to you. You may not understand its language right now, but you can observe. Perhaps you don't believe that you can express the glory of God, or you might feel resistant to the idea. You might be confusing God's glory with your culture's ideas of glory or those of your Idol. Perhaps you are intrigued and see glimpses of potential glory. How does that feel in your body? *(Pause)* If your sensations are uncomfortable, you can move your attention to an area of your body that is not reacting, and rest. When you are ready, return to observe those uncomfortable sensations. Breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Talk to Jesus

You might imagine that you are leaning back in the safe and loving arms of Jesus as together you *consider expressing the glory of God through your life*. *(Pause)* Do you judge expressing that glory as good or as undesirable? *(Pause)* What do you believe when you consider declaring God's glory? What story do you want to tell? *(Pause)* Are you afraid of loss, of effort, or of others? Do you hope for something? *(Pause)* Observe your responses as just information, and breathe with a long exhaling breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Heal

For thousands of years, human beings have had very strong feelings and have been quite confused when they have *considered expressing the glory of God through their lives*. You are also a human creature and

know what those strong feelings are like. *(Pause)* Breathe rather than reacting and getting caught up in stories about what your glory might look like or what it should look like. Let go of managing God's business. Breathe with compassion for everyone facing the challenge of expressing the glory of God through their lives. Help your body process with a long exhaling breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the integration?")

1:28 ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for this time to heal and train together. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You guide us to our glory and to the truth about what that glory looks like. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self and glory, with our community and the rest of Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about this meeting?")

1:29 ANNOUNCEMENTS

¹ www.centeringprayer.com.

² en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tapas_Acupressure_Technique.

³ Karen Horney, *Neurosis and Human Growth* (New York: Norton, 1991).

⁴ 1 John 4:17.

⁵ www.dictionary.com/browse/exult.

⁶ Matt. 5:14–16.